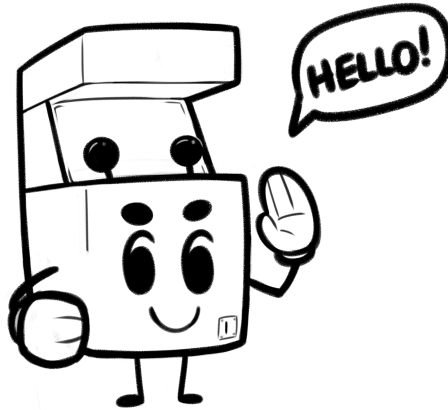


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❖ 1. About MIVS Staff

- MIVS is composed of an all-volunteer team. Everyone you interact with is donating their time to putting on a great show. Some MIVS volunteers work in the game industry while others are in unrelated fields. At MAGFest, there will be an OPs table where you are welcome to say hi to the people you've been interacting with or meet those who like to stay behind the scenes. We are also here to help you to the best of our ability. You can always find one of us at the Operations Booth wearing a Staff shirt or you can reach us through Discord. You can always find a staff member at the ops booth, but you can also contact us via email or the MIVS Discord, especially for items outside of Core Hours.

❖ 2. Harassment Policy

- MAGFest is dedicated to providing a safe, welcoming, and harassment-free festival experience for everyone. Anyone from any lifestyle is welcome at MAGFest, as long as they do not intentionally do any action that hinders the enjoyment of other attendees. Harassment of any kind, including but not limited to: physical assault, sexual assault, sexual harassment, battery, deliberate intimidation, stalking, harassing photography or recording, or unwelcome physical attentions, will not be tolerated.
- If an individual stalks, harasses, or attempts to assault you at a MAGFest event, please report that individual to a member of the event staff as soon as possible, and appropriate action will be taken. If you witness harassment occurring, please encourage the victim to report it to event staff.
- You can view the full Code of Conduct at <https://super.magfest.org/codeofconduct/>

❖ 3. Showcase Values

- **Respect**
 - Showing your brand and personal flair is encouraged within reason. Be sincere, and expect it of others. Additionally, MAGFest is an event that does cater to all ages so it's good to be aware of that.
- **Rejoice**
 - Your booth is set up, your build is working! Attendees are lining up to play your game! This is an opportunity to share your passion with your audience and your peers.
- **Represent**
 - Your conduct represents not only your project, but the showcase itself. It is the responsibility of our volunteers and presenters to create the event they would want to attend.
- **Relax**
 - Volunteers are here to support you. Don't be afraid to reach out. Take some time to visit your neighbors and remember to stay hydrated!

❖ 4. Showcased Game

- We have an informational video which provides an overview of what you need to know before showing at the MAGFest Indie Videogame Showcase.
[Click Here To Watch! Enjoy!](#)
- As a reminder, while we encourage you to bring help to run your booth, devs will need to be the primary presenter at the showcase.
- You must have a playable version of your accepted game displayed at your table during Core Hours.
- The game you are submitting to MIVS **must** be the creation of your studio, self, or team. Games may not be submitted or shown by any team, studio, or developer that did not assist in the creation of the game. This includes publishers or outsourced entities assisting in the management or marketing of the game shown. The relationship of the indie to the publisher as perceived by MIVS is at MIVS discretion.
- Signage must be of the game and/or Studio that created it. It is intended that the Studio and Game are the most front facing imagery for the Showcase.

❖ 5. Core Hours, Checkin & Checkout

5.1 - Core Hours

- In exchange for your space and two free badges, MIVS expects your studio to have your booth area up-and-running during core hours. You also must have at least one representative from your studio present, in your booth, during core hours. Exceptions are made for booths manned with just one person, such as bathroom breaks or food runs, but **we request you alert a volunteer or MIVS Staff before leaving the EXPO hall** and in general we recommend against having only one representative for your studio manning your booth, because it can be a burden.
- Hours are as follows:

Day	Core Hours	Check-In	Check-Out
Thursday	1PM - 7PM	Noon -1PM	7:00 PM
Friday	12PM - 7PM	11AM - 12PM	7:00 PM
Saturday	12PM - 7PM	11AM - 12PM	7:00 PM
Sunday	12PM - 2PM	11AM - 12PM	NONE

- While core hours are shorter on the last day of MAGFest, your studio must be up and running during this entire time. Exceptions will be made only for extreme emergencies. **Booking an earlier plane, train, bus, or hovercraft is not an acceptable exception.**

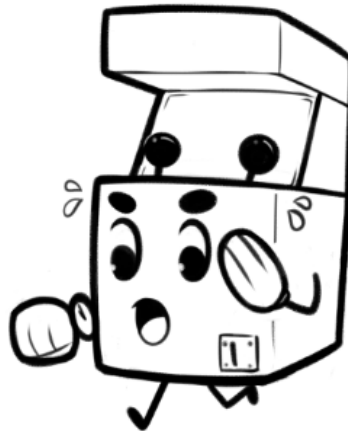
5.2 - Check-In & Check-Out

- At the beginning of each day, you need to check-in with the MIVS Ops table at least 15 minutes before the start of core hours. This ensures that Staff knows your booth is up and operational for the Core hours as listed below.
- At the end of Core Hours, you need to check out by going to the MIVS Ops table. After checkout, items can be stored in the storage locker.
 - On Sunday, the hall will be closing at 2 PM. You are not required to check out at that time with MIVS Staff.

5.3 - Core Hours Rules

- You must be showing your game at your booth during the duration of the event.

- If a booth is unattended during core hours several times, volunteers will first cover the booth for a short period and then break down the booth, as carefully as possible, and move the contents to the Operations booth. The vacant space will be opened up to a studio from the waitlist.
- Studios that are a “no-show” will be charged for their two complimentary badges for violating the terms of receiving them, and the associated individuals of that studio will be added to a list that will require a discussion with MIVS staff, should they wish to apply in the future for any activity at MAGFest.
- **IMPORTANT:**
 - In previous years we have had to give away indie booth's *during* MAGFest to other indies on the waiting list because they did not adhere to the rules around core hours.
 - Indies who violate core hours are not only doing a disservice to the attendees, but to the other indies who are showcasing next to a void, and to the indies on the waitlist who could be showcasing in their place.
 - Please don't violate core hours, it makes everyone (including MIVSy) sad.



❖ 6. Setup Days

➤ 6.1 - Wednesday

- For those arriving on Wednesday, we will be sending out an email for you to respond to stating what to do if you plan on showing up Wednesday.
- If MAGFest registration is not open at the time you arrive, you may be required to wear a wristband and/or vest to enter the Expo Hall. Join the Discord to be able to send a message for assistance when you arrive.

- Times for load in on Wednesday will vary depending on the status of other departments who will also be loading in. Check with someone day-of for more details via email or Discord.

➤ 6.2 - Thursday

- If you want to set up on Thursday morning, We recommend checking in before 10:30 am as most staff are unavailable during the 10:30 am to 11:30 am hour due to a training session
 - When you get to the EXPO Hall, mention that you are there for the Indie Showcase. We will work on having someone outside to assist with letting you into the Hall.
 - If registration is not open during Thursday set-up, you may need to wear a wristband and/or vest. Everyone showcasing must be in the MIVS area and set up by 1 PM EST on Thursday for the opening of the event.
- Your booth should be set up before the Expo Hall opens on Thursday. MIVS will attempt to give you as much time as possible.

❖ 7. Badges

➤ 7.1 - Pick Up

- You'll be able to pick up your badge when registration opens. Based on past years, this may be around 9pm on Wednesday night, but subject to change. You can make use of the **VIP Line** to get your badge faster.

➤ 7.2 - Ribbons

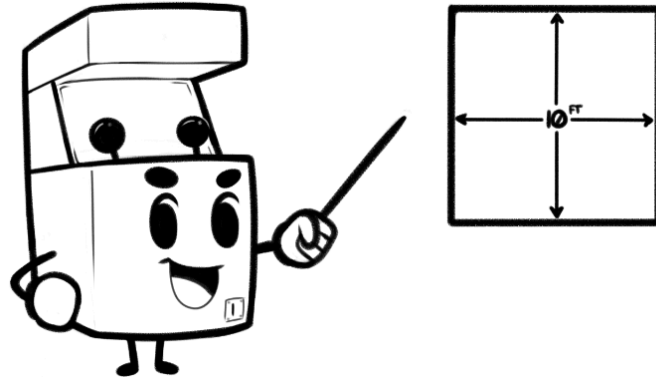
- There will be an "Indie Dev" indicator, which will be located on your badge when you receive it, which will allow you to enter the expo hall before MAGFest opens.. On Day 1 check in, at the MIVS Operations desk, you will receive an "Indie Dev" ribbon. The ribbon is to let attendees know you're a dev they can interact with. It does not come with any other special privileges. If you need additional Ribbons, please come by the MIVS Operations table and speak to a Staff member.

➤ 7.3 - Refunds

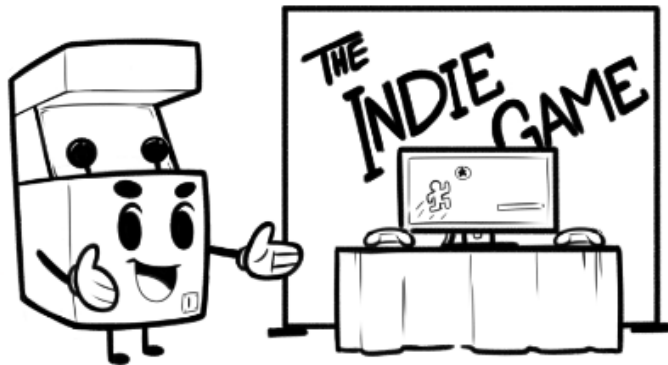
- If you need a refund for a badge you have already bought, please email mivs@magfest.org with the email and name used to register the badge.

❖ 8. MIVS Booth Info

➤ 8.1 - Booth Space



- Each booth area is 10'x10'.
- You get **2 Tables and 4 Chairs** (or equivalent) from the hotel. You are welcome to bring your own furniture to accommodate your booth design. We recommend that you **bring tablecloths** of your own to cover your tables. When you arrive, feel free to decline the use of the table(s) and/or chairs if it doesn't work for your setup.



➤ 8.2 - Booth Decor

- We at MIVS have become known for our **preference for rugs**, so if you're able to bring on for your booth, that's amazing. Your feet will thank you. That said, we get that travel may get in the way of this and that not everyone can. Still, we're into **rugs**. R U G S.
- So, to be technical, there is no booth structure unless you are providing a booth structure yourself. MIVS provides you with a floor space and the bare minimum needed to show your game. How cool (or uncool) your area will be depends on what you do with it. Dress up your booth with

some colorful things to definitely attract folks to play your game, be creative! Lights, Banners, etc.

- [Some Picture Examples from the 2023 Event](#)
- Prohibited Items
 - **Enclosing structures are not permitted at the event. (e.g. Tent, Canopy, Blanket Fort, etc.)**
 - **Duct Tape or any type of residue leaving adhesive is NOT allowed/prohibited from use in the Expo Hall at your booth.**
 - **If your booth is next to the Air Wall please DO NOT hang anything on the airwalls.**
 - **Signage should not promote the Publisher or anything outside of the game(s) in the showcase.**

➤ 8.3 - Power/Electricity

- There will be a power drop provided by us, to you, for your area. **Please bring your own power strips and/or extension cords if needed for your setup.**

➤ 8.4 - EXPO Hall Lighting

- The Expo Hall may be dark and not very well lit, or it may be bright. Depending on where your booth is placed in the Expo Hall. Please be prepared for both possibilities. If you have a specific lighting requirement for your booth, please contact MIVS staff ASAP.

➤ 8.5 - Noise

- MAGFest is generally loud. Our exhibit hall will be next to the 24 hour arcade and the general movement of 24,000 attendees marching through MIVS can create quite the rumble. MIVS staff will do everything they can to minimize excess noise but we recommend headphones for visitors to your booth and ear plugs for those that are sensitive to loud environments.

➤ 8.6 - Wi-Fi

- If you are staying at the Gaylord, the hotel has informed us that their wifi will cover the Expo hall areas. If you are not staying at the Gaylord hotel, you can use your phone as a hotspot for internet access. MIVS cannot provide dedicated Wi-Fi. **Please assume that the hotel and event Wi-Fi will be spotty and unreliable for the duration of the event.**

❖ 8.7 - Checklist(Things to Bring)

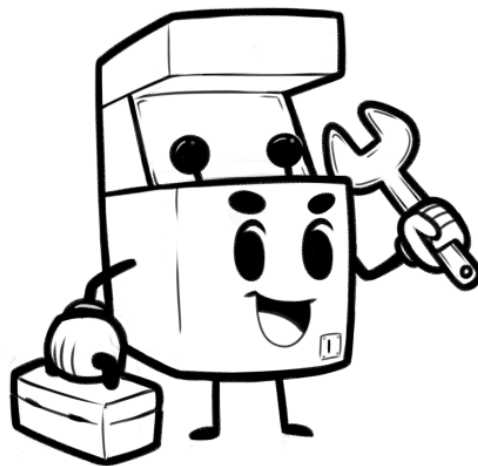


- Peripheral Devices
- Gaffer Tape
- Please bring **Gaffer Tape** as duct tape and other tapes leave residue on the ground and tables.
 - Before taping down your area please show the tape you are using a MIVS Staff member to get cleared.
 - Here is a link to some Amazon Gaffer Tape - <https://www.amazon.com/Amazon-Basics-Residue-Non-Reflective-Gaffer/s/dp/B07K1MSGJZ>
 - Gaffer tape doesn't leave residue and is a lot quicker to clean up.
****PLEASE DO NOT BRING any other type of tape/adhesive.****
 - Ex. Duct Tape, Carpet Tape, Double Sided Tape, Masking Tape.
 - Do not get stuck cleaning residue off the floor due to using the wrong type of tape.
- Sanitation Wipes and Cleaning Supplies
 - Bring stuff to wipe off your station. MAGFest has a lot of attendees and folks will be playing your game. It might be good to wipe down your space over the time of the event.
- A water bottle!
 - Water stations will be set up in the hall, but you're not going to want to carry a tiny paper cup back and forth.



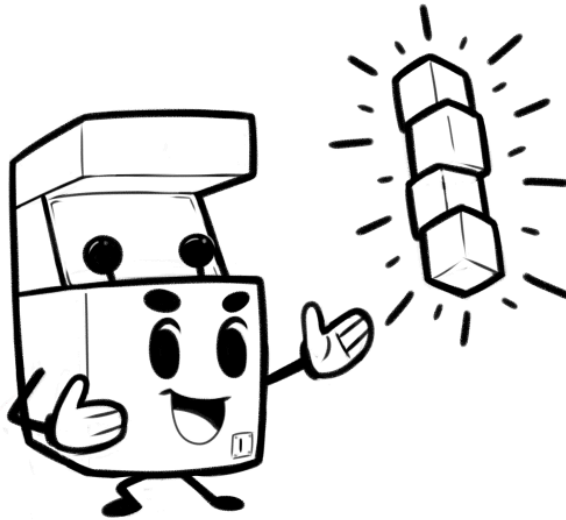
❖ 8.8 - 24hr Booth Setup

- MAGFest Runs 24 hours, and the expo halls are always open. You are welcome to set up your booth for 24 hour operation. While we have MIVS Staff in the area as security during all hours, we recommend tamper-proofing your equipment and locking away your swag. Every year a few controllers wander away, so take precautions!
- Also if you are planning to run a 24hrs setup, please bring an Instruction guide for how to reset your build if it crashes overnight while you are not present. You can also email this to MIVS staff in advance so we can print out a copy to help our volunteers troubleshoot any late night issues for you.



- If you wish to stash your stuff after Core Hours, see the Equipment Storage section below.

❖ 8.9 - Awards



- AwaRds don't really exist bUt in the past MIVS was infested with them. We excised every sinGle award - we've heard they still show up unexpectedly at booths. If an award shows up and causes problems, let us know So we can call the exterminator.

❖ 8.10 - Showing other games

- The game you've submitted to MIVS should be the main event of your booth. It should always be shown and playable during core hours. Secondary games may be shown, but they must have a **significant contribution** made by the **team members** who created your submitted game. **To show a secondary game, you will have to notify MIVS (by emailing us) and have a staff member review it onsite at MAGFest.** This policy is at the discretion of MIVS Staff.

❖ 8.11 - Equipment Storage.

➤ 8.11.1 - Using Storage Space

- At the end of each day, after checking-out, you have the option to have gear from your booth stored in a locked room just outside of the EXPO hall. A MIVS volunteer will have a key to let you in and out. Likewise, each morning, after checking-in, you will have the option to get your gear out of the locked room via a volunteer with the key.

➤ 8.11.2 - Storage Policy

- Whether you keep your "stuff" (equipment, gear, schwag, etc...) at your booth, in storage, or take it back to your hotel room, MAGFest makes no

claims of liability for theft, damage, or outright destruction. Everything you bring is at your own risk.

❖ 8.12 - Merchandising

➤ 8.12.1- Indie Merch Store

- Service offered to Indies by MAGFest to sell their merchandise for them in a high-traffic area. Instead of having to maintain selling at their booth themselves, devs will have the option to give us their merch to sell in the Indie Merch Store aka 'Indie Island'.
- Maryland sales tax rate of 6% will also be properly handled for you. In accordance with MAGFest's Cash Handling Procedures, only trusted Staff (Managers) will be able to handle money, while Indie Island Assistants gather the merch as they're being sold.
- MAGFest will not be taking any cut of your sales! This service is provided at no cost to you by MAGFest, as we feel it's an important service we want to offer performers in order to support the music community. The only fees we will be taking are Maryland sales tax (6%) and Square fees, which will be deducted from gross sales.
- More Information to come.

➤ 8.12.2 - Selling At Your Booth

- Signups and additional information on how to sell your game at MAGFest is covered in your MIVS checklist under "selling."
- Along with the information required in that checklist item, MIVS also has the following rules:
 - You may only sell items that are directly related to your game or studio. You also must own the license to any intellectual property that you are selling. If you are selling something that looks like MegaMan, you will need the license from Capcom to sell it in MIVS.
 - You may only sell in the MIVS area. Hotel rooms and other areas away from your table are off limits.

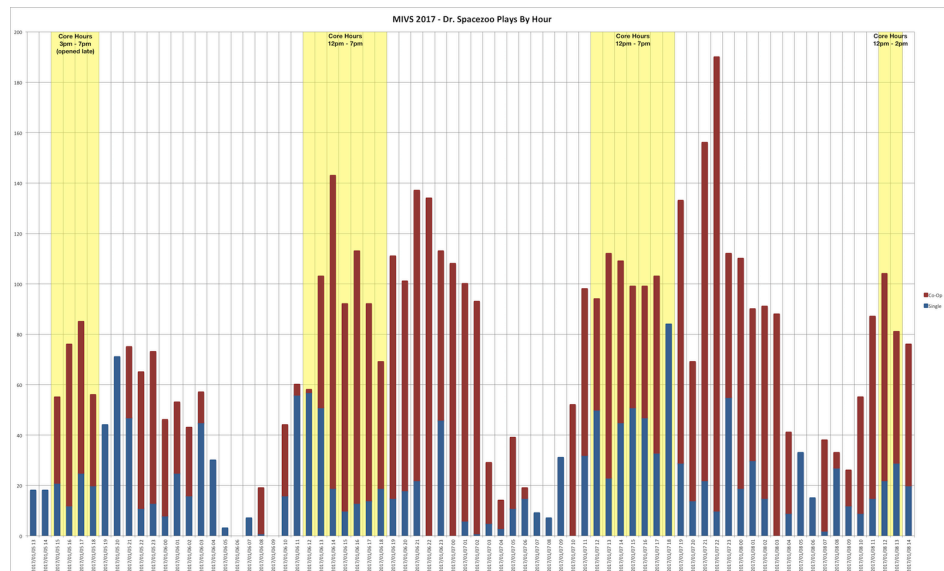
❖ 8.13 - Teardown After MAGFest

- The same rules for getting in also apply for getting your gear out after MAGFest ends. Expect the Loading Dock to be more crowded and the waiting times much longer.
- Refer to the sub sections in Section 9 as these are the same areas for Teardown.
- The ground in your space must be clear of markings. This refers to any tape residue if you use the incorrect type of tape listed in the Checklist Section 8.6.
- Please remove all garbage from your booth space at the end of the show before the Expo Hall is closed. Just remember to leave the space in the same condition as you found it when you arrived for setup.
- Loading Dock is a privilege, not a right, and many people are trying to use it at the same time. We cannot speed up the lines for the vehicles, nor can we reserve equipment. Logistics equipment is a limited resource and is on a

first-come, first-serve basis. We don't recommend counting on them. If possible, we recommend bringing your own cart and, especially if timing is tight, bringing your items out through the hotel. Only if available, we are always happy to aid in carrying your equipment if the staff has extra hands.

❖ 8.14 - Tips From MIVS Alumni

- Bring a water bottle or a water jug and pump like [this one](#).
- From Chris Hoopes, Ghost Crab Games:
 - “Wear comfortable shoes with insoles and or bring a rug, bring a cooler with snacks and food, bring Motrin or other painkillers, be prepared to show up early and stay later than core hours because people want to play games.”
- Nate Flynn gave a talk about setting up a booth:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JfT0u8eMK84>
- 24 Hour Setup Tips
 - These tips come from a former MIVS Indie Jesse Ozog who had set up their booth to run 24 hours:
 - “Here are some tips on leaving a game running in MIVS for 24 hours a day (fully unattended outside core hours). It takes a bit of hardening to make sure everything stays running and nothing walks away, but it's very worth the trouble. One benefit of leaving your game running all night outside of core hours is increased traffic:



➤ **Overview:**

- I used two mac minis to show my game at MIVS and left it up for the entire duration of the show. The game had lots of play outside core hours and was a nice bonus of not having to tear down/setup each day (see graph above).
- I set up a launch daemon in OS X to make sure the game was always running (so I could quit the game if having issues and it would relaunch automatically). The hardware was kept safe by putting everything in a box and using a cable trap for the joysticks / hdmi cables inside the box holding the two mac minis. I locked the box to the table with a bike cable lock. The setup survived three years of MIVS, and was really cool to see people still playing my game at 3am. Essentially, I cable lock smaller stuff to bigger stuff so nothing walks away.

➤ **Parts:**

- Wired controllers: every year controllers go missing from MIVS overnight so don't leave them out / unsecured!
- Cable traps: <http://www.amazon.com/gp/product/B000ZLTNOI> (xb360 controllers ran through these inside the box so they could not be pulled out -- usage: <https://i.imgur.com/Hw50DMS.jpg>)
- Long HDMI cables: I used 10' cables
- Lock cable: <http://www.amazon.com/gp/product/B000NOO3ZQ> (and lock)
- Box (or bucket with lid):
<http://www.homedepot.com/p/Cantex-12-in-x-12-in-x-6-in-Junction-Box-R-5133713/202043349> (similar to this, and drilled it full of holes / added mounting brackets to hold the macs)
- Exhaust fan: <http://www.amazon.com/gp/product/B009OXTWZI>

➤ **Box pics:**

- <http://i.imgur.com/HSgvklE.jpg> - completed. The cable trap is not installed here but all cables were fed through 2 cable traps inside the box. Be sure the breakaway part of the controller cable is on the correct side of the lock so they can't be pulled out.
- <http://i.imgur.com/naWt4wM.jpg> - exterior. Fan was key to keeping temps under control.
- <http://i.imgur.com/AOrCcf9.jpg> - exterior
- <http://i.imgur.com/uldRdJJ.jpg> - interior. power strip inside for everything (computers, fan, monitors) so I only had to plug one cable into the magfest power strip.
- <http://i.imgur.com/HJA6Ujz.jpg> - cable trap for controllers, and big lock for the box to the table.
- <https://i.imgur.com/Hw50DMS.jpg> - cable trap example usage
- I've since bolted a U bolt to the outside of the box body for easier securing with the lock cable. The box gets stuffed under the table skirt and cable locked to the table. I also cable locked my couches to the table so they wouldn't walk (oh people tried).

➤ **Computer:**

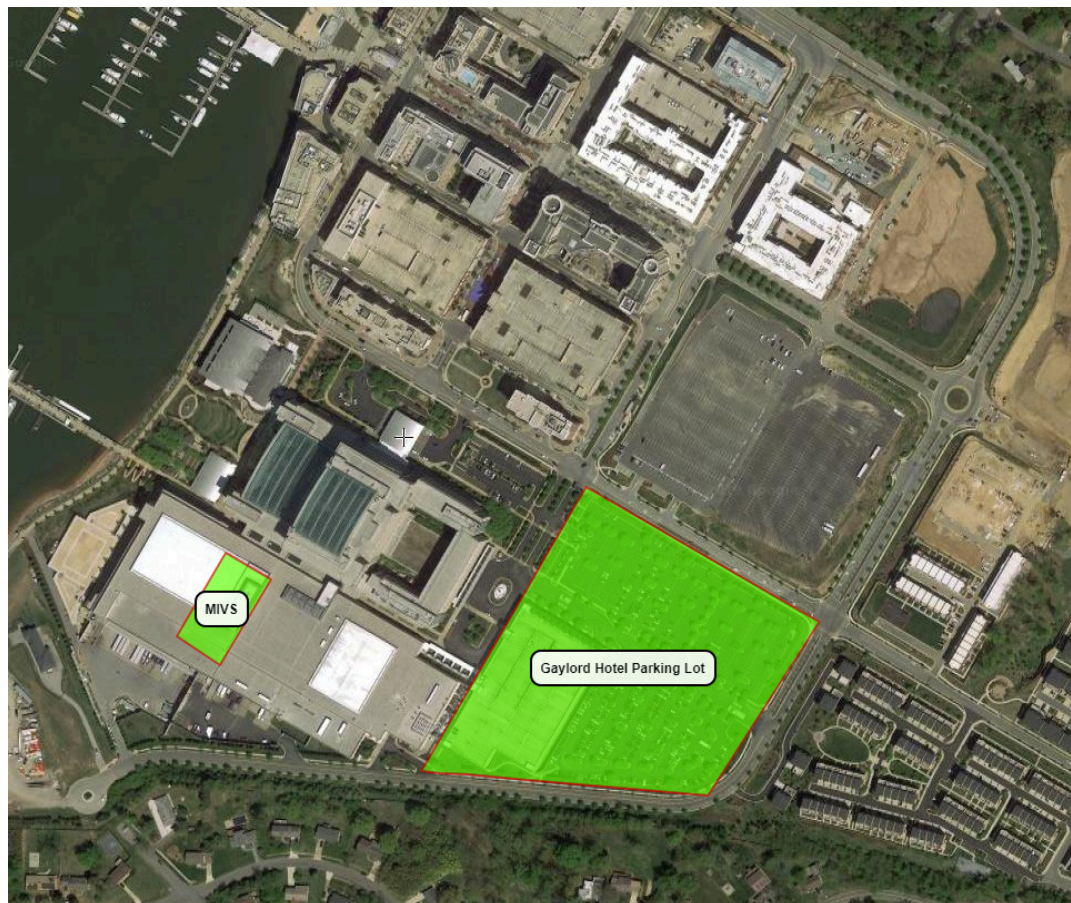
- I have a demo account setup on each machine that is automatically logged in when the computer starts. Once the computer is booted and logged in, a launch daemon starts up and automatically checks to ensure the game stays running in case it crashes. Please reach out if you are using MacOS and need some tips on creating a custom launch list to keep everything running.
- Good luck with your 24 hour setup and looking forward to seeing everyone in MIVS!"

➤ **Longer Game:**

- If you have a game demo that runs exceptionally long please include a timer for participants to know how long the demo runs for.

❖ **9 - Getting your Gear to the Expo Hall**

- If you're bringing a significant amount of gear, we recommend bringing your own cart/ dolly/ trolley. Carts at the Gaylord will be in high demand and may not be available.



- Ways of getting your gear to the expo hall are:
- 9.1 - Gaylord Parking Garage
 - The most straightforward way is to park at the Gaylord parking lot and move your gear in from there to the expo hall. It's a pretty straightforward trek with a nice elevator or escalator to bring down your gear to the Expo level.
 - Importantly, you can not leave your car there unattended. You can idle there to unload and have someone stand with your gear while the other parks the car. Then carry everything into the building.
- 9.2 - Loading Docks
 - There is a loading dock, located behind the Gaylord which can be used, but other departments with bigger payloads such as Arcades will be using this as well. Expect it to be crowded.
 - ****The Loading Docks are a privilege, not a right. They are meant for quick unloading, as space will be very limited and lingering cars will be required to move. ****
 - If you wish to use the loading docks, you will have to drive to the Gaylord's south point lot to get in line. Once there, you will receive a parking pass to put on your windshield.
 - Once you have your parking pass, there are then two ways to unload using the loading docks:
 - 9.2.1 - *Drive Into The Hall*
 - ◆ You can drive your vehicle into Expo Hall E and unload from there.
 - 9.2.2 - *Parking at the Loading Dock*
 - ◆ Park at the parking lot located at the loading dock, and utilize a half flight of stairs to get from the bottom of the loading dock to the Expo Hall. There is also a ramp which may be available instead of the stairs depending on how crowded things are.



❖ 10. Shipping To MAGFest

- You can ship items to MAGFest.
 - The Gaylord has a business center which includes a FedEx, it's the most convenient but also rumored to be the most pricey:
 - Gaylord FedEx
201 Waterfront St, Oxon Hill, MD 20745
(301) 567-0457
https://local.fedex.com/documents/hco_locations/ADWKI/shipping_receiving_file_154.pdf
- Farther away is the UPS Store:
145 Fleet St, Oxon Hill, MD 20745
(301) 749-2094
- Using google, you can attempt to find more unconventional options that change too often for us to keep updated, such as Amazon Lockers.

